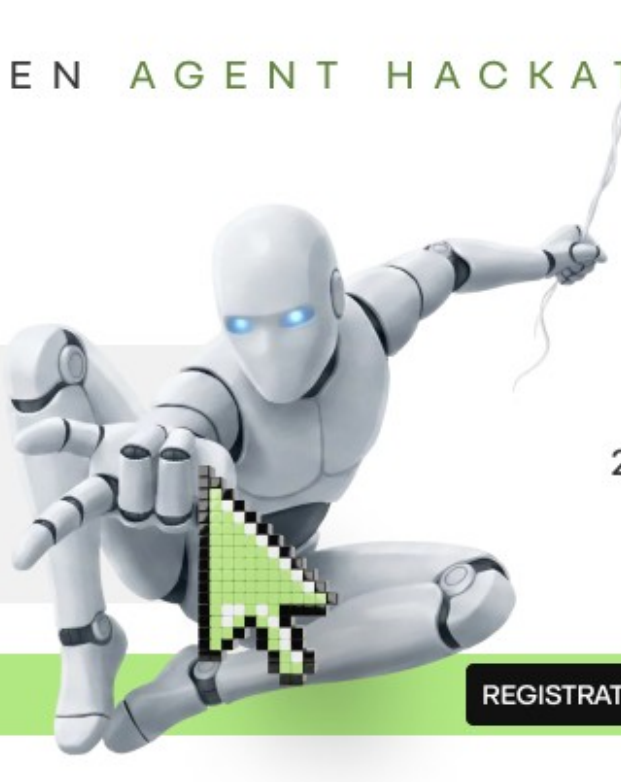
OPEN AGENT HACKATHON 2026

Build an agent

that does real work.

Connect data, understand context, and turn intelligence into action.



GenAI.works

22–27 October 2026

144 Hours Fully Online

Teams of 1-5

ZETARIS NVIDIA METERLESS

Up to $20,000 in Prizes

REGISTRATION CLOSES 22 OCTOBER

hackathon.genai.works

Participant onboarding

21 October 2026 · 12:00–13:30 UTC · All times UTC

Here’s the plan →

01 Why this hackathon exists

02 The event at a glance

03 Three tracks and a bonus track

04 Sponsor technology

05 Building and submitting

06 Judging and prizes

07 Support and next steps

08 Q&A

THE MISSION

Not another chatbot.
An agent that does the work.

Build something that finds the information it needs, understands how the pieces relate, reasons across several steps, holds on to what matters, and turns all of that into an outcome someone can use.

The whole thing, in four numbers

144

hours to build,
22–27 October

3 + 1

challenge tracks,
plus one bonus track

1–5

builders per team,
solo welcome

$20k

in prizes,
up to

Fully online. Everything runs on HackOS.

Free to enter. Open worldwide, 16 and over.

All times UTC

How the week runs

12 OCT	21 OCT	22 OCT	22 OCT	27 OCT	28 OCT	6 NOV
Data Day workshop	**Onboarding**	**Build window opens**	**Registration closes**	**Submit**	**Judging opens**	**Results**
Recording on HackOS	You are here	00:00	23:45, hard stop	By 23:45	As soon as submissions close	16:00, with certificates

Build Day and Power Day workshops are announced on HackOS. Every workshop is recorded and published on HackOS.

Registration stays open until the end of the first build day, so latecomers can still join.

All times UTC

Pick one track. Build for it.

TRACK 01

Solving Fragmented Intelligence

Demonstrate a clever ability to discover and work across fragmented data sources.

TRACK 02

The Agent That Can Explain Why

Build agents that investigate complex questions across multiple data sources, connect findings, and produce evidence-backed answers or recommendations.

TRACK 03

Reasoning Architecture

Demonstrate a novel ability to turn data, knowledge, memory, and reasoning into reliable decisions and actions.

BONUS · TINKERER

Bring Your Own Project

Bring an existing project and extend it with Zetaris and Meterless. Scored only on the new work built during the hackathon.

One team, one track. Full track pages are on HackOS.

One of these scores. One does not.

Weak

- A fixed chain: A passes to B passes to C
- Agents that are prompt wrappers
- No critique, no validation
- No shared state or memory
- No retries or recovery
- A demo path that only works once

Strong

- Tasks delegated based on context
- Outputs challenged and revised
- Planner, executor and evaluator loops
- Shared context carried across steps
- Branching, retries and escalation
- Traces showing how it got there

Quality of interaction matters more than number of agents

The sponsor stack

REQUIRED

Zetaris

Serve and work with your data

REQUIRED

Meterless

Local and cloud engines to build and run faster

REQUIRED DEV ENVIRONMENT

Cursor

Build your project in Cursor, with Space XAI

WHERE IT CONTRIBUTES

NVIDIA

Cloud compute for your build

THE WORKSHOPS

Data Day 12 October

Zetaris: serving internal data. Recording on HackOS

Build Day Announced on HackOS

Cursor, GenAI Works and Meterless: how to build, and how to build faster

Power Day Announced on HackOS

NVIDIA and Meterless: cloud and local compute for your agent

Sponsor Tech is worth **10 points.** Zetaris and Meterless go into every submission. Each sponsor has a Help channel on HackOS.

Workshop recordings are published on HackOS

Build it however you like

Models

Open choice, including closed-source models and paid APIs.

Frameworks

LangGraph, CrewAI, AutoGen, the OpenAI Agent SDK, LangChain, or your own stack. The framework is not scored.

Data

Open data you can use legally. Keep samples small, add download scripts, and avoid sensitive or restricted data.

Existing work

Declare any pre-existing components in your submission. The bonus track is scored only on new work.

Secrets

Never commit keys. Use a local .env, add it to .gitignore, and ship a .env.example with placeholders.

Environment

Build in Cursor, with Space XAI. Wire in Zetaris and Meterless from the start, not at the end.

The Official Rules on the event page have the full list

What lands in the submission

01 Demo video
One to four minutes, agent in action

02 Slide deck
Required. Problem, user, solution, architecture

03 GitHub repository
README with run instructions. Colab links if used

04 Sponsor tech explanation
How you used Zetaris, Meterless, Cursor and NVIDIA

05 Pre-existing components
Declare anything built before 22 October

06 Project details
Name, description, team members and track

Submissions close **27 October, 23:45 UTC.** Hard deadline. Submit on HackOS. Your team locks at first submission.

Final requirements are published in the Official Rules

100 points on the table

Criterion	Points
Impact	30
Technical	20
Innovation	15
Demo	15
Product & UX	10
Sponsor Tech	10
Total	**100**

What judges reward

- A real problem and a clear user
- Agents that act, not describe
- Critique, retries and recovery
- Reliable execution
- Sponsor tech used where it helps
- An output someone could actually use
- A demo that explains itself

At least three judges score each submission. Ties go to the higher Impact score, then the earlier submission.

Judging opens 28 October, as soon as submissions close

Up to $20,000 in prizes

Track	1st	2nd	3rd
Track 01 · Solving Fragmented Intelligence	**$2,000**	$1,350	$1,000
Track 02 · The Agent That Can Explain Why	**$2,000**	$1,350	$1,000
Track 03 · Reasoning Architecture	**$2,000**	$1,300	$1,000
Bonus · Tinkerer	**$1,000**	$600	$400

$15,000

in cash

$5,000

in-kind sponsor prizes

- Paid by bank transfer within 30 days of the results
- Split equally across the team unless you agree otherwise in writing
- Winners are announced with certificates on 6 November, 16:00 UTC

Taxes are the recipient's responsibility. Full prize terms are in the Official Rules.

Put these in your calendar

Date (UTC)	Milestone
12 October	Data Day workshop: Zetaris (recording on HackOS)
21 October, 12:00–13:30	Participant onboarding
22 October, 00:00	Build window opens
22 October, 23:45	Registration closes
27 October, 23:45	**Submissions close**
28 October	Judging opens
6 November, 16:00	Winners announced, with certificates

Build Day and Power Day dates are announced on HackOS →

All times UTC

Stuck? Here’s where to go

When you need	Go to
Questions during the build	#help desk on HackOS
Sponsor setup and errors	Help Zetaris, Help Meterless, Help Cursor, Help NVIDIA
Agent design and debugging	Mentor office hours
Teammates	Team-finding on HackOS
Official updates	Announcements on HackOS, check daily
Rules questions	hackathons@genai.works

Mentors help you understand the tracks, navigate the tools and get unstuck. They will not build your project. Discord is the community space for after the hackathon.

Everything during the event happens on HackOS

Do these eight things →

01 Complete your profile on HackOS

02 Confirm your team, or choose to build solo

03 Decide your track

04 Watch the workshop recordings

05 Set up Zetaris, Meterless and Cursor

06 Sketch your agents and how they interact

07 Build a small working loop on day one

08 Log agent activity from the start

Build window opens 22 October, 00:00 UTC

Build something someone could use.

Six days. One track. An agent that finds what it needs, works through the problem, recovers when something breaks, and hands back something useful.

Questions? The #help desk and mentor office hours are open on HackOS.